

NextRound Sample — Application Diagnosis + Rewrite

A fictional sample application pack showing how a weak, generic graduate application can be diagnosed and rewritten into a clearer, role-targeted application.

No real applicant data used. This sample is designed for public demonstration. It shows the thinking behind a rewrite, not just the finished CV and cover letter.

TARGET APPLICANT

Recent business / marketing graduate

TARGET ROLE

Junior Marketing Assistant

SERVICE FOCUS

Diagnosis, rewrite, and explanation

Applicant context

The applicant has useful experience, but the original application does not connect it clearly to junior marketing work.

FICTIONAL APPLICANT

Emma Walsh

Recent Business and Marketing graduate with part-time retail/customer service experience and university project work.

TARGET ROLE

Junior Marketing Assistant

Supporting campaigns, writing short-form copy, helping with market research, tracking performance and coordinating with the team.

MAIN CHALLENGE

Too broad

The original CV describes a general graduate rather than someone with a clear interest in marketing support and customer-focused communication.

CONTEXT NOTE

This sample keeps the applicant realistic. Retail and university project experience are treated as transferable evidence, not inflated into professional marketing campaign ownership.

Original weak CV excerpt

This version is not disastrous. It is believable, but it is vague, interchangeable and under-targeted.

BEFORE · ORIGINAL ISSUE

WEAK BUT REALISTIC

PROFILE

Recent Business and Marketing graduate looking for an opportunity to start my career. I am a hardworking and organised person with good communication skills. I have experience working in retail and completing university projects. I am keen to learn new skills and work as part of a team.

EXPERIENCE EXCERPT

Retail Assistant

- Served customers, worked on the till and helped keep the shop tidy.
- Worked as part of a team and helped with general daily tasks.

DIAGNOSIS PREVIEW

The issue is not that the applicant lacks potential. The issue is that the application makes the recruiter do too much work to see the connection between the applicant's background and the Junior Marketing Assistant role.

Application diagnosis

A strong rewrite starts with judgment: what to highlight, what to leave out, and what not to exaggerate.

DIAGNOSTIC FINDINGS

Too generic

The profile could be used for marketing, admin, sales or customer service. It does not yet sound like a marketing application.

Missing role alignment

The original version does not reflect campaign support, social media captions, email copy, market research, campaign performance, digital marketing or customer awareness.

Underused experience

Retail experience is relevant because it shows customer awareness, communication, product presentation and calmness in a busy environment. The original version barely uses this.

Weak evidence

Claims such as “hardworking” and “organised” are common. The rewrite needs examples that show these qualities through actions.

Avoid exaggeration

The applicant should not claim to have managed campaigns, owned brand strategy or delivered major growth results. The truthful angle is support-level readiness.

REWRITE BRIEF

The revised application needs to show interest in marketing specifically, connect existing experience to the job description, and use clearer evidence while keeping the applicant’s level honest.

Improved CV profile

The rewritten profile positions the applicant for the role without pretending they are already an experienced marketer.

AFTER · IMPROVED VERSION

ROLE-TARGETED PROFILE

Recent Business and Marketing graduate seeking a Junior Marketing Assistant role, with a strong interest in campaign support, content writing and customer-focused marketing. Brings part-time retail experience, university project work and a practical understanding of how clear communication, audience awareness and attention to detail support effective marketing. Comfortable writing short-form content, researching competitors and trends, working to deadlines and contributing within a busy team. Looking to build hands-on experience across social media, email marketing, market research and campaign performance tracking.

WHAT CHANGED

The opening now names the target role and uses marketing-specific language from the job description.

WHAT STAYED TRUTHFUL

The profile presents entry-level readiness and transferable experience, not senior-level results or invented campaign ownership.

Improved experience bullet points

Ordinary experience becomes stronger when it is translated into evidence that matters for the role.

Retail Assistant

Part-time experience

- Delivered friendly, professional customer service in a busy retail setting, building confidence in customer communication and understanding common customer questions, preferences and buying behaviour.
- Supported product presentation and store standards by keeping displays tidy, checking stock placement and helping ensure promotional items were clearly visible to customers.
- Handled till transactions and customer queries carefully, developing attention to detail and the ability to stay calm during busy trading periods.
- Worked closely with colleagues during peak times to manage competing tasks, support daily operations and maintain a positive customer experience.

University Marketing Project

Academic project experience

- Contributed to a group marketing project by researching a target audience, reviewing competitor activity and helping shape practical recommendations for a campaign concept.
- Drafted sections of a written report and presentation, using clear, concise language to explain research findings and proposed marketing actions.
- Prepared sample social media caption ideas and campaign messages as part of a university assignment, focusing on tone, audience fit and clarity.
- Reviewed basic campaign performance measures, such as engagement, reach and customer response, to understand how marketing activity can be assessed and improved.

Tailored cover letter

The letter adds motivation and context without repeating the CV word-for-word.

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Junior Marketing Assistant role. I recently completed a Business and Marketing degree and am now looking for an entry-level marketing position where I can build practical experience across campaign support, content writing, research and digital marketing.

During my degree, I became particularly interested in how marketing decisions are shaped by customer understanding, clear messaging and competitor research. In university projects, I contributed to audience research, reviewed competitor activity and helped prepare written reports and presentations. I also drafted sample social media captions and campaign ideas as part of my coursework, which helped me develop a better understanding of tone, audience fit and attention to detail.

My part-time retail experience has also been useful preparation for this type of role. Working directly with customers has helped me understand how people respond to products, promotions and service. It has also strengthened my communication skills, reliability and ability to work in a fast-paced team environment.

I am interested in this role because it offers the opportunity to support a range of marketing activity, from social media and email copy to research and campaign tracking. I would bring a positive attitude, strong written communication, attention to detail and a willingness to learn from more experienced team members.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my academic background, customer service experience and interest in digital marketing could support your team.

Yours sincerely,
Emma Walsh

ATS keyword notes

Keywords should support the evidence. They should not be forced into the application without truthful backing.

KEYWORDS FROM THE TARGET ROLE

Junior Marketing Assistant

Marketing campaigns

Campaign support

Social media captions

Email copy

Market research

Campaign performance

Digital marketing

Written communication

Attention to detail

Customer awareness

Team coordination

Fast-paced team

Competitor research

Content writing

Audience understanding

Keywords reflected in the rewrite	Campaign support, content writing, social media captions, email marketing, market research, customer awareness, competitor activity, campaign performance, digital marketing, written communication, attention to detail and fast-paced team.
Keywords to include only if truthful	SEO, Google Analytics, Meta Ads, paid social, Canva, Mailchimp, CRM, copywriting portfolio, campaign reporting, content calendar management, influencer marketing and website CMS.
Why this matters	The improved application uses role language naturally. It does not stuff keywords into the document or imply technical skills the applicant has not actually used.

Likely interview questions

Each question is linked to what the employer may be testing and what a strong graduate-level answer should cover.

01 Why are you interested in this Junior Marketing Assistant role?

Why they might ask it

They want to know whether the applicant understands the role and is genuinely interested in marketing, not just any graduate job.

A strong answer should mention

Practical marketing work, campaign support, content writing, research, learning from a team and building early professional experience.

02 What did you learn from your Business and Marketing degree that would help in this role?

Why they might ask it

They want to connect academic learning to workplace tasks.

A strong answer should mention

Audience research, customer behaviour, competitor analysis, marketing planning, written assignments and presenting recommendations clearly.

03 Tell us about a university project you worked on.

Why they might ask it

They are testing teamwork, communication, research and deadline management.

A strong answer should mention

The project aim, the applicant's role, how the team divided work, what research was completed and what the final output was.

04 How would your retail experience help you in a marketing role?

Why they might ask it

They want to see whether the applicant can translate customer service experience into marketing relevance.

A strong answer should mention

Customer awareness, communication, understanding customer questions, noticing promotions and product presentation, and staying calm in a busy environment.

05 How would you approach writing a social media caption for a campaign?

Why they might ask it

The job includes writing short-form content.

A strong answer should mention

Audience, platform, tone, key message, call to action, clarity and checking details before publishing.

06 What do you understand by campaign performance?

Why they might ask it

The role involves tracking campaign performance, likely at a basic support level.

A strong answer should mention

Simple measures such as engagement, clicks, reach, open rates, enquiries or customer response, depending on the campaign.

07 How do you manage deadlines when working with other people?

Why they might ask it

Marketing teams often work quickly and across several tasks.

A strong answer should mention

Planning early, agreeing responsibilities, communicating progress, asking questions early and checking work before submission.

08 What area of marketing do you most want to develop?

Why they might ask it

They want to understand motivation and growth potential.

A strong answer should mention

A genuine area of interest, such as social media, email marketing, campaign reporting, content writing or customer research, while showing openness to learning across the full role.

Explanation of changes

The rewrite improves clarity and relevance while keeping the applicant's background honest.

Generic → Specific

The original relied on broad traits. The rewrite shows customer communication, product awareness, research, writing and deadline management through concrete examples.

Disconnected → Role-aligned

The improved version mirrors the Junior Marketing Assistant job description: campaign support, social captions, email marketing, market research and performance tracking.

Passive → Confident

The language now uses active verbs such as delivered, supported, handled, contributed, drafted, prepared and reviewed.

Inflated → Truthful

The applicant is not presented as an experienced marketer. The application shows entry-level potential, transferable skills and a realistic willingness to learn.

IMPROVEMENT LOGIC

The revised application makes it easier for a recruiter to see the match between the applicant's background and the role. It does not create a different candidate; it presents the existing candidate more clearly.

Disclaimer

This page clarifies the boundaries of the sample and the service.

This is a fictional sample created for demonstration purposes. The applicant, details and examples are not based on a real person, and no real personal data is used.

NextRound does not add fake experience, invent qualifications or claim achievements the applicant cannot support. The purpose of the service is to diagnose weak or generic applications and rewrite them in a clearer, more truthful and role-targeted way.

NextRound does not guarantee interviews, job offers or hiring outcomes. Final recruitment decisions are made by employers.

USE CASE

This sample is designed to show how a human-reviewed application diagnosis can turn ordinary early-career experience into a more focused application while preserving honesty and credibility.